

MURMUR

Anonymous Community Intelligence Platform

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Design System	NeoBrutalism

// 01 — EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Product Overview

Murmur is an anonymous, organisation-scoped discussion and community intelligence platform. It gives employees, students, and fellows a dedicated space to post thoughts, reactions, gossip, feedback, and opinions, completely separated from professional channels like Slack, WhatsApp, or Discord, where such content creates noise and violates community guidelines.

Every user is Anonymous. No display names. No avatars. No public profiles. The only identity that matters is the organisation a user belongs to, verified by their institutional email address.

Murmur is built for exclusivity. Each organisation gets its own isolated feed. Users from Company A will never see posts from Company B. This is enforced at the infrastructure level.

The Problem

Organisations running communities through WhatsApp groups, Discord servers, or Slack workspaces face a persistent challenge: members use those channels for gossip, drama, venting, arguments, and off-topic discussions. This:

- Pollutes professional or learning-focused channels
- Violates community guidelines and creates moderation overhead
- Suppresses authentic opinions due to fear of social consequences
- Buries important announcements and discussions

The Solution

Give that energy its own home. Murmur is where the gossip lives. It is intentional, contained, and anonymous. By separating this behaviour into its own platform, organisations preserve the integrity of their main channels while still giving their communities a legitimate outlet.

// 02 — TARGET MARKET

Target Audience

Primary Segments

SEGMENT	DESCRIPTION	EXAMPLE
Fellowship Programmes	Cohort-based programmes with active community channels	Learn2Earn NG
Universities & Polytechnics	Students using .edu or institutional emails for community access	ABU, UNILAG, Covenant University
Tech Companies & Startups	Teams wanting anonymous internal culture feedback	Flutterwave, Paystack, Cowrywise
NGOs & Nonprofits	Staff and beneficiary communities needing anonymous outlets	TeenovateX Labs, HelpMum

Beachhead Market

Learn2Earn NG is the first and primary deployment target. The programme already has the exact community behaviour Murmur is built for: a high-energy cohort of young fellows, active WhatsApp groups and Discord channels, and a need to preserve professional channels while still giving fellows a legitimate voice.

// 03 — CORE PRODUCT CONCEPT

How Murmur Works

The Anonymous Identity Model

Every user who signs up on Murmur is assigned the identity: Anonymous. No username. No avatar. No bio. No public profile. Even the user themselves cannot view their own profile page.

Internally, Murmur maintains a hidden identity record for each user. This record is only accessible to platform administrators. It is never exposed to other users under any circumstances. It exists solely for moderation, abuse prevention, and data compliance.

Organisation Isolation

Murmur enforces strict feed isolation by organisation. When a user signs up, they must use an institutional or company email address. A one-time password (OTP) is sent to that email for verification.

- Generic email providers are blocked: gmail.com, yahoo.com, outlook.com, and similar are rejected at the signup stage.
- OTP verification ensures the person actually has access to that institutional inbox, preventing impersonation or use of a company email one no longer controls.
- Once verified, the user is permanently scoped to that organisation's feed.
- A user from learn2earn.ng can only see posts from other learn2earn.ng email holders. Feeds never cross.

Post Lifecycle

1. User writes a Murmur (post): text, a reaction, a question, or a poll.
2. Post is published to the organisation's feed with the author shown as Anonymous.
3. Other users in the same organisation can Like, Comment, React, or Repost.
4. Comments are also anonymous. Reposts appear in the same feed attributed to Anonymous.
5. Posts can be reported. Reports are reviewed by Murmur admins only.

// 04 — FEATURE SPECIFICATIONS

Feature Requirements

Priority: P0 = Must have at launch | P1 = First 60 days | P2 = Roadmap

Authentication & Onboarding

FEATURE	DESCRIPTION	PRIORITY
Institutional Email Signup	User registers with a company or school email. Generic domains (gmail, yahoo, outlook) are blocked with a clear error message.	P0
OTP Verification	A 6-digit OTP is sent to the institutional email. Valid for 10 minutes. Resend allowed after 60 seconds. 5 failed attempts locks the session.	P0
Organisation Auto-Detection	System extracts the domain from the email and maps it to an existing or new organisation. If domain is new, a pending org is created awaiting admin approval.	P0
Anonymous Account Creation	Upon verification, account is created with no visible identity. User sees no profile page.	P0
Session Management	JWT-based sessions. Auto-logout after 30 days of inactivity. Option to logout manually.	P0
Re-verification on New Device	When logging in from a new device, a fresh OTP is required to confirm identity.	P1

Feed & Discovery

FEATURE	DESCRIPTION	PRIORITY
Organisation-Scoped Feed	Users only see posts from their verified organisation. Feed is reverse-chronological by default.	P0
Trending Feed	A secondary tab showing posts sorted by engagement (likes + comments + reposts) in the last 24 hours.	P0
Hot / New Toggle	Users can switch between Hot (algorithmic) and New (chronological) view.	P1
Post Categories / Tags	Optional tags on posts: Gossip, Opinion, Question, Rant, Announcement, Poll. Users can filter by tag.	P1
Search	Full-text search within the organisation's feed. No user-level search. No cross-org search.	P1

FEATURE	DESCRIPTION	PRIORITY
Pinned Posts	Admins can pin up to 3 posts to the top of the feed for announcements.	P2

Posting & Interaction

FEATURE	DESCRIPTION	PRIORITY
Create Murmur	Rich text post with up to 500 characters. No media uploads in v1 to reduce abuse surface.	P0
Like	Tap to like. Like count visible. No breakdown of who liked.	P0
Comment	Thread-style anonymous comments on each post. Max 280 characters per comment.	P0
Repost	One-tap repost to the same feed. Reposts show the original post content.	P0
Emoji Reactions	5 fixed reactions beyond Like: Fire, Shocked, LOL, Agree, Cap (disbelief). Reaction counts visible.	P1
Polls	Post a poll with 2 to 4 options. Polls run for 24h, 48h, or 7 days. Results visible after voting.	P1
Image Uploads	Allow image attachments on posts, with automated NSFW filtering.	P2

Moderation & Safety

FEATURE	DESCRIPTION	PRIORITY
Report Post	Any user can report a post. Report reasons: Hate Speech, Harassment, Spam, Misinformation, Other.	P0
Admin Review Queue	Murmur platform admins review all reports and can delete posts or warn/ban accounts.	P0
Auto-Profanity Filter	Basic keyword filter runs on every post before publishing. Blocked content is rejected with a warning.	P0
Shadow Ban	Admins can shadow-ban a user. Their posts appear to them but are invisible to others.	P1
Account Suspension	Repeat offenders can have accounts suspended. They receive an email at their institutional address.	P1
AI Content Moderation	Integrate an AI moderation layer (Perspective API or OpenAI Moderation) to flag toxic content.	P2

Organisation Admin Portal

FEATURE	DESCRIPTION	PRIORITY
Org Registration	Organisation registers via a separate onboarding flow. Provides org name, domain, and a contact email.	P0
Domain Whitelist Management	Admins can add or remove allowed email domains for their organisation.	P0
Feed Analytics Dashboard	View aggregate post volume, top categories, engagement trends. No individual user data shown.	P0
Org-Level Branding	Orgs can upload a logo and set a primary colour for their Murmur space.	P1
Custom Community Guidelines	Orgs can add their own rules alongside Murmur's global rules, displayed to users on signup.	P1
Data Export	Admins can export anonymised aggregate insights as CSV or PDF reports.	P1

// 05 — MONETISATION STRATEGY

Revenue Model

Tier 1: Free (Community Tier)

Available to all organisations. Includes basic feed, posting, reactions, and moderation tools. Capped at 500 members per organisation. This is the acquisition layer.

Tier 2: Pro (Organisation Tier) — Paid

- Unlimited members
- Advanced analytics dashboard
- Custom branding and community guidelines
- Priority moderation support
- Data export (anonymised CSV reports)
- Pinned posts and Polls feature

Pricing: Flat monthly fee per organisation. Suggested starting price: \$29/month for up to 1,000 members, scaling by seat count.

Tier 3: Enterprise Intelligence — Premium

This is the data monetisation play. At scale, Murmur sits on a significant dataset of anonymous, organisation-scoped community sentiment. This tier offers:

- Monthly or quarterly Culture Intelligence Reports: anonymised, aggregated trend analysis of what people inside an org are discussing, how sentiment shifts over time, top concerns, and engagement peaks.
- Benchmarking: How does your org's engagement and sentiment compare to industry peers (anonymised).
- Pulse Surveys: Scheduled anonymous surveys sent to the org's Murmur feed.

Pricing: Custom contract. Estimated \$200 to \$500/month per organisation.

Data Ethics Guardrails

All data sold or reported at the Enterprise tier must be:

- Fully anonymised: no individual can be identified.
- Aggregated: minimum cohort size of 10 per data point to prevent inference.
- Consented: users are informed on signup that anonymised aggregate data may be used for insights.
- Compliant: NDPA (Nigeria Data Protection Act) and GDPR-adjacent standards.

// 06 — TECHNICAL ARCHITECTURE

Technical Specifications

Core Stack (Recommended)

LAYER	TECHNOLOGY	RATIONALE
Frontend (Web)	Next.js + Tailwind CSS	SSR for performance, fast NeoBrutalism implementation
Frontend (Mobile)	React Native (Expo)	Cross-platform iOS and Android from one codebase
Backend / API	Node.js + Express or Fastify	Lightweight, fast, familiar JS ecosystem
Database	PostgreSQL	Relational integrity for org scoping and audit trails
Auth	Custom JWT + OTP via Resend	No third-party auth to protect anonymity architecture
Hosting	Vercel (Frontend) + Railway (Backend)	Fast deployment, scalable, affordable for early stage
Email OTP	Resend or Mailgun	Reliable transactional email at low cost
Moderation AI	Perspective API (Phase 2)	Free at low volume, scalable

Data Model: Key Entities

Users

- id (UUID, internal only)
- email (hashed, stored encrypted, never exposed)
- org_id (foreign key)
- status: active, suspended, shadow_banned
- created_at, last_active_at

Organisations

- id, name, domain
- tier: free, pro, enterprise
- logo_url, primary_color
- status: pending, active, suspended

Posts (Murmurs)

- id, org_id, user_id (internal only), content, category_tag
- like_count, comment_count, repost_count
- status: published, removed, shadow_removed
- created_at

Anonymity Architecture

The anonymity guarantee is enforced at the database query layer, not just the API layer:

- user_id is never returned in any public-facing API response.
- Join queries that would link a post to a user record are forbidden in the public API scope.
- Admin queries are isolated to a separate internal API, protected by separate authentication with audit logging.
- All admin access to user identity records is logged with timestamp, action taken, and admin ID.

// 07 — DESIGN SYSTEM

NeoBrutalism Design Language

Murmur's visual identity is built entirely on NeoBrutalism: raw, unapologetic, high-contrast, and deliberately anti-polished. The aesthetic signals honesty and boldness, which matches the product's core premise.

Core Design Principles

PRINCIPLE	IMPLEMENTATION
Thick borders	All UI cards, buttons, inputs, and containers have a 2 to 4px solid black border.
Hard shadows	Offset box shadows (4px 4px 0px #000) replace soft drop shadows everywhere.
High contrast	Black on yellow. White on black. No gradients. No blur. No opacity tricks.
Flat colours	Primary palette: Yellow (#FFE500), Black (#000000), White (#FFFFFF), Red (#FF3B00).
Bold typography	Headlines in Arial Black or Space Grotesk Bold. Body in DM Mono or Inter.
No rounded corners	Border radius is 0 everywhere. Sharp corners only.
Interactive states	On hover, shadow offsets increase. On click, shadow collapses. Button physically depresses.
Visible grid	The layout grid is almost visible. Blocks feel deliberately placed, not floated.

Post Card Anatomy

Each Murmur post card renders as:

- Black 3px border on all sides with 4px 4px black hard shadow
- White background, zero border radius
- Yellow tag badge for the post category
- 'Anonymous' label in bold, all caps, with a randomly generated icon per session
- Post text in Inter 14px
- Action row at the bottom: Like count, Comment count, Repost button, Report flag

// 08 — PRODUCT ROADMAP

Launch Phases

Phase 0: Validation (Month 1)

- Deploy Murmur exclusively for Learn2Earn NG fellows
- Manual org onboarding — no self-serve portal yet
- Basic feed, posting, likes, comments, OTP email verification
- Admin moderation queue (manual review)
- Gather qualitative feedback from fellows

Phase 1: Core Product (Month 2 to 3)

- Self-serve org registration and onboarding
- Polls, emoji reactions, post category tags
- Trending feed algorithm
- Basic analytics dashboard for org admins
- Auto-profanity filter, Pro tier payment integration

Phase 2: Scale (Month 4 to 6)

- Mobile app (React Native)
- AI content moderation (Perspective API)
- Enterprise Intelligence reports, benchmarking, and Pulse Surveys
- Onboard 5 to 10 additional organisations

Phase 3: Ecosystem (Month 7 to 12)

- API for organisations to integrate Murmur data into internal dashboards
- White-label option for large enterprises
- Multi-language support (Hausa, Yoruba, Igbo for Nigeria)
- Expand to Ghana, Kenya, South Africa

// 09 — RISKS & MITIGATIONS

Risk Register

RISK	LIKELIHOOD	MITIGATION
Anonymity misused for harassment	High	OTP ties account to real email. Admins can de-anonymise and act. Shadow ban and suspension available.
Orgs reject 'gossip' framing	Medium	Position as 'community intelligence' and 'anonymous feedback' in org-facing sales materials.
Low post volume kills network effect	Medium	Seed Learn2Earn cohort aggressively. Add prompts and conversation starters to new feeds.
Data breach exposes user emails	Low-Medium	Emails are hashed and encrypted at rest. Internal admin API is separated from public API.
Legal exposure from toxic content	Medium	Clear ToS, automated moderation, active admin queue, and a legal takedown process.
Copycat by larger platform	Low	Moat is org-level data and community trust, not the feature set. Move fast, lock in orgs early.

// 10 — SUCCESS METRICS

KPIs & Success Criteria

Phase 0 — Learn2Earn Pilot

- 50+ posts in first 2 weeks
- 40% of fellows create at least one post
- Average 3+ comments per post
- Zero serious moderation incidents in week 1

Phase 1 — 3 Months Post-Launch

- 5+ organisations onboarded
- 1,000+ total users across all orgs
- At least 1 Pro tier conversion
- Daily active users: 30% of total registered users

Phase 2 — 6 Months Post-Launch

- 20+ organisations onboarded
- 5,000+ total users
- \$500+ MRR from Pro tier
- First Enterprise Intelligence contract signed
- NPS score above 40 from org admins

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